SANKUR KUNDU

ML Systems Engineer | LLM Training, Inference & GPU Kernels
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linkedin.com/in/sankur-kundu • github.com/Shakhtar-Sankur • shakhtar-sankur.github.io • **evidence for every claim**
7 fixes merged in 13 days at Apple, Meta, Oxford & Hugging Face • collision-risk work under review by NASA CARA

TECHNICAL SKILLS

ML systems: PyTorch, JAX, MLX; GRPO, DDP, ZeRO/FSDP, MoE expert parallelism, paged KV cache, int8 quantization
Languages & GPU: Python, C++20, CUDA (tensor cores), Rust, C, Swift, SQL; Triton-style kernels, Metal, Pallas (TPU)

OPEN-SOURCE CONTRIBUTIONS: SEVEN FIXES MERGED IN 13 DAYS, 16–28 OCT 2026

APPLE MLX | Apple's ML framework for Apple silicon, **29k★** | PR #4737 **Merged 22 Oct 2026**
- Fixed a data race in the backend that links Macs for distributed training (ThreadSanitizer: 2–4 races per run → **0**); reviewed, approved and merged by MLX maintainer @zcbenz.

META EXECUTORCH | On-device AI in Instagram & WhatsApp, **5.1k★** | #23677, #23912 **Merged 16 & 28 Oct 2026**
- **Two fixes merged** into Meta's on-device LLM kernels: closed an out-of-bounds read in the 2/4-bit embedding kernels and fixed checks aborting valid fp16-scale models; approved by Meta's Scott Roy ("LGTM! Thanks for the fix!") and Jacob Stevens.

JAXMARL | NeurIPS 2024; BOLD Lab: Oxford, UCL & Imperial, **868★** | PR #206 **Merged 26 Oct 2026**
- Fixed the rollouts behind 8 Q-learning baselines, which zeroed each new episode's first observation; approved and merged by lead author Alex Rutherford: "Good find!!"

OXFORD PYZX | Quantum-circuit optimiser, **553★** | PR #563 **Merged 22 Oct 2026**
- Fixed a rewrite that broke **25 of 100** random Clifford circuits; merged by co-creator John van de Wetering: "Thanks for the fix! This was a regression from an earlier PR."

HUGGING FACE OPENENV | RL environments (Meta-PyTorch, NVIDIA, Microsoft), **2.8k★** | #1441, #1442 **Merged 19 Oct 2026**
- Fixed reward rubrics that ran hooks out of order and scored async judges as coroutines; reviewer: "177 rubric tests pass."
- **In review:** Google JAX (**36.5k★**; Google assigned it to JAX co-author Matthew Johnson), vLLM (**95.7k★**), NVIDIA, PyTorch, MIT, Carnegie Mellon, ETH Zurich (cleared by its maintainer, merging after CI).

HONORS & RECOGNITION

- **NASA CARA** (NASA's conjunction-assessment team): my reproduction of its Monte Carlo collision probabilities (**53/53** cases, **15–19×** faster per core) is **under review by NASA CARA**, referred by its Operations Team Lead (emails).
- **Entrepreneur First** (UK): its Talent Investor scouted me from public work alone, citing tessel's cuBLAS-parity GEMM, switchyard's MoE serving and a negative result I published, "which I rarely see" (email).

RESEARCH (SOLE AUTHOR)

- **"Removing the Token Tax from an Existing Model"**, **"The Sampler Was Not the Policy"**, **"Reproducing NASA CARA's Monte Carlo Probability of Collision"** (arXiv, forthcoming).

PROJECTS

ratchet | PyTorch, C++/CUDA: RL post-training (GRPO) from scratch | study page
- Lifted Qwen2.5-0.5B on GSM8K from **48.1% to 52.5%** in 100 steps on 2× T4, scoring all 1,319 test problems.
- Cut weight sync **369×** with in-place GPU updates, and made steps **1.9×** faster by overlapping generation with training.
- Found fp16 weight sync silently erasing most updates, so the sampler ran a policy the trainer never had (gap **5.2** → **0.04** nats).

tessel | Rust: a tile language and compiler for GPU and TPU kernels | study page
- Matched **cuBLAS** on GEMM (**1.00–1.04×**) and beat PyTorch SDPA on causal attention (**1.3–1.9×**) on a T4, checked against fp64.
- Built an LLM engine on these kernels alone that matches **vLLM token for token at 1.05× its throughput** (TinyLlama-1.1B).

lipi | PyTorch: cutting the token tax on Indian languages | study page
- Built a tokenizer that needs fewer tokens than **GPT-4o's and Gemini's in 23 of 24** Indian languages (on Hugging Face).
- Extended Qwen2.5-0.5B with it: Odia takes **8.6×** fewer tokens and, in equal GPU time, is predicted **20% better**.

samebit | C, CUDA, PyTorch, MLX: LLM inference in integers, the same bits on every chip
- Ran **Qwen2.5-0.5B (494M parameters) entirely in integers**: within **0.75%** of float32 perplexity and **bit-identical on an NVIDIA T4 GPU and an x86 CPU**, while float16 on the same GPU drifts by 0.25.

More projects
- **ink-sensitivity**: official Vesuvius ink model finds **79%** of real ink moved into an unread scroll (**AUC 0.94**).
- **relay**: fault-tolerant LLM serving on custom kernels, prefill **8.7×** faster, **384/384** requests identical through 60 kills.
- **syndrome**: GPU quantum decoder bit-identical to **IBM's**, **28.7×** faster per shot; **kessler**: matches **NASA CARA** on 53/53.
- **switchyard**: MoE serving **2.2×** Hugging Face; **kiln**: beats torch.compile on CPU; **crucible**: **0 of 9** reward hacks pass.

EXPERIENCE

GIGZEN | Co-founder & Founding Engineer | Bhubaneswar, India **Apr 2026 – Present**
Early-stage startup (name approved by India's MCA; incorporation in progress) | Sole engineer
- Built Waggle, three delivery apps on one PostgreSQL backend: **53 tables, 90 RLS policies, 154 SQL functions**; **150 attacks** blocked.
- Moved dispatch, UPI reconciliation and GST billing into the database, so no client can bypass them.

EDUCATION

IEM KOLKATA | B.Tech, Computer Science and Engineering (AI & ML) | Kolkata, India **Sep 2022 – Apr 2026**